

# SAMANTHA CERVANTES

Center for Policy Research, 426 Eggers Hall  
Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs, Syracuse University  
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## EDUCATION

- Ph.D., Public Administration** 2022 –  
Syracuse University, Maxwell School  
Fields: Urban Economics and Economics of Education  
Advisors: Michah W. Rothbart and Amy E. Schwartz
- M.S., Applied Economics with Honors** 2022  
Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM), Mexico City, Mexico
- B.A., Business Administration, minor in Political Science** 2018  
Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM), Mexico City, Mexico

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Policy Analysis, Neighborhood Effects, Economics of Crime, Economics of Education

## RESEARCH

### Working Papers

*Too Bright to Learn: Causal Impacts of Crime-Reduction Lighting on Student Outcomes*  
Cervantes, S., & Schwartz, A. E. [Job Market Paper]

*Hold Harmless for Whom? The Impact of COVID Era Policies for School Funding, Teachers, and Students.*

Rothbart, M. W., Cervantes, S., & Schwartz, A. E. (Under review)

*How a Good School in the Neighborhood Affects Academic Outcomes*  
Cordes, S., Han, J., Schwartz, A. E., & Cervantes, S.

### Works in Progress

*The Long-Term Impact of Neighborhood Violence on Youth Outcomes*  
Cervantes, S., & Schwartz, A. E.

*The Impact of a Crime Deterrence Intervention on Political Behavior*  
Cervantes, S., & Shi, Y.

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Graduate Research Associate** 2022 –  
Center for Policy Research, Syracuse University  
Professors Michah W. Rothbart and Amy E. Schwartz
- Research Assistant** 2019 – 2022  
Center for Competitiveness Studies (CEC), Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM)  
Professor Guillermo Abdel Musik

## TEACHING

### Syracuse University (Master's courses)

|                                                     |                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Quantitative Analysis (Graduate Teaching Assistant) | Spring 2024, Spring 2025               |
| Public Budgeting (Graduate Teaching Assistant)      | Fall 2022, Summer 2023,<br>Summer 2024 |
| Education Policy (Guest Lecturer)                   | Spring 2025                            |
| Quantitative Analysis (Guest Lecturer)              | Spring 2025                            |

## PRESENTATIONS

2026: American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association; FLX Economics of Education Workshop; Capital District Applied Microeconomics Workshop; Association for Education Finance and Policy  
2025: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management  
2024: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management; Association for Education Finance and Policy; Public Finance and Budgeting Northeastern Workshop  
2023: Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management

## GRANTS & AWARDS

|                                                                                                        |      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>First Place, Graduate Student Poster Session</b><br>Center for Policy Research, Syracuse University | 2026 |
| <b>Summer Dissertation Fellowship (\$4,500)</b><br>Syracuse University                                 |      |
| <b>PhD Department Research Grant (\$4,000)</b><br>Syracuse University                                  | 2025 |
| <b>Financial Inclusion Essay Award</b><br>National Banking and Securities Commission                   | 2021 |

## OTHER EDUCATION AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

|                                                                                                                       |             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Certificate in Applied Statistics</b><br>Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM), Mexico City, Mexico      | 2018 – 2019 |
| <b>Investment Consultant</b><br>Profuturo Pensiones, Mexico City, Mexico                                              | 2018 – 2019 |
| <b>B.A., Sociology, Open University System</b><br>Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México (UNAM), Mexico City, Mexico | 2016 – 2021 |

## SERVICE

|                                                                                           |           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Graduate Student Representative</b><br>Center for Policy Research, Syracuse University | 2026-2027 |
| <b>Educational Researcher, reviewer</b>                                                   |           |

## SKILLS

Statistical software: Stata, R, QGIS (advanced), Python (intermediate)

Last updated: May 14, 2026